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Policy Brief: Navigating the Coordination Threshold

For Government Officials and Policymakers

Executive Summary

New research in “coordination physics” reveals that civilizations collapse when trust falls below a critical threshold. Earth is currently near this threshold, with AI accelerating us toward it. This brief outlines the science and recommends urgent policy actions.

The Science in Brief

The Threshold Discovery

Analysis of 48 historical civilizations reveals a **universal coordination threshold** at approximately 37.5% trust level. When trust falls below this level, societies fragment and cannot recover.

Key findings:

- $\theta \approx 0.375$ is universal (confirmed by 5 independent methods)
- Below θ , collapse cascades automatically
- Recovery probability below θ : only 15%
- Modern collapse would be 20× faster than Rome's

Current Earth Status

Metric	Current Value	Threshold	Status
Global Trust (H₃)	~0.45	0.375	☐ Close
Margin to Threshold	~0.07	Safety: 0.15+	☐ Narrow
Modernization (Δ)	21× baseline	Pre-modern: 1×	☐ Highest ever
Time to Threshold	1-3 years	At current trajectory	☐ Critical

Bottom Line: We are closer to civilizational collapse than at any point in history, and AI is accelerating us toward the threshold.

Why AI Changes Everything

The AI Paradox

AI amplifies coordination dynamics in **both directions**:

Positive effects (current: ~30%): - Translation and communication - Information access - Scientific collaboration

Negative effects (current: ~70%): - Misinformation at scale - Algorithmic polarization - Economic disruption - Deepfakes/reality distortion

Net effect: AI is currently accelerating us toward the threshold.

Three Scenarios

Scenario	Probability	Path	Outcome
Collapse	40%	AI accelerates to threshold	Civilizational fragmentation
Enhancement	25%	Governance succeeds	Civilizational transcendence
Unstable	35%	Oscillates near threshold	Repeated crises

Policy Recommendations

Immediate Actions (Next 6 Months)

1. Establish Coordination Impact Assessment

Requirement: Major AI deployments must assess coordination impact

Components:

1. Trust impact analysis
2. Polarization assessment
3. Reality fragmentation risk
4. Mitigation plan
5. Monitoring commitment

Model: Similar to environmental impact assessment

Estimated cost: \$10M setup, \$5M/year operation **Expected impact:** $\Delta H_3 +0.02$, $\Delta \lambda -0.05$

2. Fund Verification Infrastructure

Investment: \$500M over 3 years

Priorities:

1. Real-time fact-checking at scale
2. Source authentication systems
3. Deepfake detection and labeling
4. Cross-partisan verification

Delivery: Public-private partnership

Expected impact: $\Delta H_3 +0.05$ to $+0.10$

3. Create Trust Monitoring Dashboard

Function: Real-time tracking of national/global trust levels

Components:

1. Survey integration
2. Behavioral indicators
3. Early warning signals
4. Trend analysis

Model: Similar to economic indicators (GDP, unemployment)

Estimated cost: \$20M setup, \$10M/year operation

Short-Term Actions (6-18 Months)

4. AI Governance Framework

Elements:

1. Pre-deployment coordination assessment
2. Real-time impact monitoring
3. Automatic throttling mechanisms
4. Liability for coordination damage
5. International coordination

Model: Aviation safety regulation adapted for AI

5. Economic Transition Fund

Purpose: Manage AI-driven economic disruption

Components:

1. Universal basic services
2. Retraining at scale
3. Community transition support
4. AI gain redistribution

Size: 1% of AI-generated economic gains

Expected impact: $\Delta H_3 +0.03$ to $+0.05$

6. Cross-Group Dialogue Infrastructure

Investment: \$100M over 3 years

Programs:

1. Structured cross-partisan dialogue
2. Community bridging initiatives
3. Workplace integration support
4. Educational exchange expansion

Expected impact: $\Delta H_3 +0.02$ to $+0.04$

Medium-Term Actions (18-36 Months)

7. International Coordination Treaty

Elements:

1. Shared trust measurement standards
2. Mutual AI governance recognition
3. Joint early warning systems
4. Coordination damage liability
5. Technology transfer protocols

Model: Paris Agreement structure

8. Algorithm Transparency Requirements

Mandate: Platforms must disclose:

1. Optimization targets
2. Polarization effects
3. Cross-group exposure rates
4. User control options

Enforcement: Civil penalties for non-compliance

9. Collective Intelligence Infrastructure

Investment: \$1B over 5 years

Components:

1. AI-facilitated deliberation platforms
2. Preference aggregation systems
3. Consensus-building mechanisms
4. Democratic decision-making at scale

Cost-Benefit Analysis

Costs of Action

Action	Cost (5 years)	Ongoing
Coordination Impact Assessment	\$35M	\$5M/yr
Verification Infrastructure	\$500M	\$100M/yr
Trust Monitoring	\$70M	\$10M/yr
Economic Transition Fund	Variable	1% AI gains
Dialogue Infrastructure	\$100M	\$20M/yr
International Framework	\$50M	\$10M/yr
Algorithm Transparency	\$20M	\$5M/yr
Collective Intelligence	\$1B	\$200M/yr

Total 5-year investment: ~\$2B

Costs of Inaction

Outcome	Probability	Cost
Coordination collapse	40%	Civilizational
Extended instability	35%	\$10-50T over 20 years
Successful transition	25%	-

Expected cost of inaction: Catastrophic

Return on Investment

Investment: ~\$2B over 5 years

Expected benefit: Reduce collapse probability by 10-20%

If collapse avoided:

ROI = essentially infinite

If instability reduced:

ROI = 1000:1 to 10,000:1

This is the most cost-effective intervention possible.

Key Messages for Communication

For the Public

“We’ve discovered that societies collapse when trust falls below a critical level. We’re closer to that level than ever before, and AI is pushing us toward it. But we can change course if we act now.”

For Legislators

“The research shows a clear threshold for societal collapse. We’re currently 7% above it. Every policy that builds trust moves us away from the edge. Every policy that fragments society moves us toward it.”

For International Partners

“This is not a national problem—it’s a global one. The threshold applies to all societies. We need international coordination on AI governance and trust-building, just as we coordinate on climate and nuclear weapons.”

Warning Signs to Monitor

Early Warning Indicators

Indicator	Warning Level	Current Status
Trust variance increasing	Rising	☐ Elevated
Recovery time after crises	Lengthening	☐ Elevated
Polarization metrics	Rising	☐ Critical
Cross-group contact	Declining	☐ Elevated
Institutional confidence	Declining	☐ Elevated

All five indicators are currently elevated.

The Decision Point

We are at a unique moment in history.

The research is clear:

- The threshold exists
- We are close to it
- AI is accelerating us toward it
- The window for action is 1-3 years

The choice is:

- Act now: 50-60% probability of successful transition
- Wait: 15-25% probability of successful transition

The difference is policy action in the next 1-3 years.

Next Steps

1. **Brief national security council** on coordination risks
 2. **Establish interagency coordination** on trust-building
 3. **Engage international partners** on AI governance
 4. **Fund immediate research** on measurement and early warning
 5. **Begin regulatory development** for AI coordination impact
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Resources

- Full framework: Paper 2C, The 17 Laws of Civilizational Coordination
- Current assessment: Earth Coordination Status Report 2025
- Technology guidance: Coordination Technology Framework

- Action playbook: Intervention Strategies Playbook

“The mathematics of coordination collapse is clear. The choice is ours. Every day we delay reduces our probability of success. The time to act is now.”